Anti-Obesity Medication Overview

A comprehensive guide to FDA-approved medications for chronic weight management — reviewed by your provider

PHENTERMINE RX

Phentermine

Adipex-P · Lomaira · Suprenza

Dose: 15–37.5 mg PO qAM · Schedule IV

Action: Sympathomimetic amine · appetite suppressant

Side FX: Headache, ↑BP, rapid HR, insomnia, tremor, overstimulation

Avoid if: **Hypertension, CAD, hyperthyroidism, glaucoma, seizures, drug abuse, pregnancy**

Age: ≥16 for obesity

ORLISTAT OTC AVAILABLE

Orlistat

Xenical (120mg Rx) · Alli (60mg OTC)

Dose: 120mg TID with fatty meals (Rx) · 60mg OTC

Action: GI lipase inhibitor — blocks dietary fat absorption

Side FX: Oily discharge/flatus, gallstones, kidney stones, fat-soluble vitamin malabsorption (A/D/E/K)

Avoid if: **Malabsorption syndrome, cholestasis, warfarin use**

Age: ≥12 for obesity

NALTREXONE/BUPROPION RX

Naltrexone / Bupropion

Contrave

Dose: Titrate: 8/90mg tablet · 1 AM → 2AM+2PM

Action: Opioid antagonist + antidepressant combo

Side FX: Nausea, constipation, headache, vomiting, dizziness, insomnia, dry mouth

Avoid if: **Uncontrolled HTN, seizure disorder, opioid use, acute glaucoma, drug/alcohol withdrawal, pregnancy**

Age: ≥18 for obesity

PHENTERMINE/TOPIRAMATE RX

Phentermine / Topiramate ER

Qsymia · Schedule IV

Dose: Start 3.75/23mg → target 7.5/46mg → max 15/92mg QAM

Action: Appetite suppressant + anticonvulsant combo

Side FX: Paresthesia, dizziness, dysgeusia, insomnia, constipation, dry mouth, ↑HR, mood changes

Avoid if: **Pregnancy (teratogenic — orofacial clefts!), glaucoma, hyperthyroidism, MAOI use**

Age: ≥18 for obesity

LIRAGLUTIDE GLP-1 RX

Liraglutide

Saxenda (obesity) · Victoza (diabetes)

Dose: SC injection: 0.6→1.2→1.8→2.4→3.0mg/day weekly titration

Action: GLP-1 receptor agonist · reduces appetite

Side FX: Nausea, diarrhea, vomiting, headache, dizziness, abdominal pain, fatigue

Avoid if: **Medullary thyroid cancer (personal/family), MEN2, pancreatitis, gallbladder disease, renal failure, pregnancy**

Age: ≥12 for obesity

SEMAGLUTIDE GLP-1 RX

Semaglutide

Wegovy (obesity) · Ozempic (diabetes)

Dose: Wegovy: 0.25→0.5→1→1.7→2.4mg SC weekly

Action: GLP-1 receptor agonist · ~15% avg weight loss

Side FX: Nausea, diarrhea, vomiting, constipation, abdominal pain, headache, fatigue, belching

Avoid if: **Medullary thyroid cancer (personal/family), MEN2, pancreatitis, gallbladder disease, diabetic retinopathy, pregnancy**

Age: ≥18 for obesity

TIRZEPATIDE GLP-1/GIP RX

Tirzepatide

Zepbound (obesity) · Mounjaro (diabetes)

Dose: 2.5→5→7.5→10→12.5→15mg SC weekly (4wk steps)

Action: Dual GLP-1 + GIP agonist · ~20–25% avg weight loss

Side FX: Nausea, diarrhea, vomiting, constipation, abdominal pain, headache, fatigue

Avoid if: **Medullary thyroid cancer (personal/family), MEN2, pancreatitis, gallbladder disease, diabetic retinopathy, pregnancy**

Age: ≥18 for obesity

METFORMIN RX

Metformin

Glucophage · off-label for weight

Dose: 500mg PO daily → titrate to 2000mg/day

Action: Exact weight loss mechanism unclear; improves insulin sensitivity

Side FX: Lactic acidosis (rare, serious), GI upset, malaise

Avoid if: **eGFR <30, metabolic acidosis, DKA, dehydration, hypoxemia, hepatic insufficiency**

Age: ≥10 for T2DM

Your Weight Loss Journey

Medications are tools — not magic. Each drug works best combined with:

- Reduced-calorie diet plan
- Regular physical activity
- Behavioral modification
- Regular follow-up visits

Questions? Call us at (281) 557-0300